

Ada Kim

UX Research Lead | AWS Certified Cloud & AI Practitioner | Mixed-Methods Research Expert

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Seattle, Washington - U.S. Permanent Resident

Professional Summary

AI product UX researcher with 5+ years of experience leading high-impact, end-to-end research projects that drive product strategy and user-centered design decisions. Proven track record of increasing business metrics through strategic research initiatives, including 28% profit increase and 6% streaming growth. Expert in evaluating AI-powered user experiences using both qualitative and quantitative methodologies. AWS Certified Cloud & AI Practitioner.

Professional Experiences

Pebblous - UX research lead

Feb 2023 - Mar 2025

Led 0-to-1 research for B2B SaaS product serving enterprise clients in AI/ML data quality evaluation system

- **Established comprehensive UX strategy, roadmap, and target user segments** in early product development to address the needs of both users (data practitioners) and customers (enterprise decision-makers)
- **Designed an AI-powered, semi-automated reporting framework** that made an ML engine's raw outputs interpretable and trustworthy for enterprise users, working cross-functionally with design and engineering teams
- **Synthesized and communicated research findings to stakeholders**, resulting in product showcases at CES 2024 and 2025 and strategic partnerships with enterprise clients including Hyundai Motors

Banksalad - Mixed-methods UX researcher

Aug 2020 - Jan 2023

Executed end-to-end behavioral research for a million-user financial platform across development lifecycle stages

- **Drove product strategy through data-driven insights** by establishing Critical User Journeys (CUJ) in collaboration with product manager, design teams, engineering teams, and executive leadership
- **Increased annual profit by 28%** through triangulated research approach combining behavioral analytics, survey research, and in-depth user interviews to inform loan product decisions

Kakao Corp. - Quantitative UX researcher

Jan 2020 - May 2020

Optimized music recommendation algorithm UX for a high growth, 6 million user platform

- **Improved streaming count by 6% (primary KPI) and new-user acquisition by 9%** through a large-scale ML experimentation combining heuristic evaluation, usability testing, and A/B testing methodologies
 - **Collaborated with data scientists and ML engineers** to improve the quality of a music recommendation system
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AI-Augmented Practice & Community Engagement

AI UX Case studies | Apr 2026 - Present

Independent audit of a published sycophancy benchmark's LLM-as-a-judge methodology (ELEPHANT, ICLR 2026), spun off from planning a multimodal AI study

- Authored and published an original 2x2 framework distinguishing perceived satisfaction from actual benefit in AI use, synthesizing recent sycophancy and wellbeing research (Medium)
- Extended the benchmark's single-judge (GPT-4o) pipeline to a three-judge architecture spanning OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic models to test whether benchmark scores depend on judge identity
- Hand-coded evaluation data against the paper's published rubric and quantified human-judge agreement (Cohen's κ)

- Designed a full-scale judge-swap experiment (3 judges × 2 temperature conditions × 2,000 prompts) using Fleiss' κ as the primary reliability measure

AIPKM (AI for Personal Knowledge Management) - Community Member | Jun - Nov 2025

- Built transcription-to-synthesis pipeline using Gemini Pro and Google Docs)
- Executed Evernote migration using Cursor as AI coding assistant

Changbal (Korean-American IT Community, Seattle) - Organizing Member | Feb 2025 - Present

- Hosted Changbal Tech Summit (CTS) 2025, the community's annual flagship event

Product Management Bootcamp | Jun - Sep 2025

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner & AI Practitioner | Feb - Apr 2025

Core Competencies

Research Methods. Mixed-Methods Research · Generative & Evaluative research · User Interviews · Usability Testing · A/B Testing · Behavioral Analytics · Survey Design · Statistical Analysis · Heuristic Evaluation

AI & Technical Skills. LLM-Augmented Research Workflows · Prompt Engineering · Claude · Cursor · Python · R · SPSS · SQL · Amplitude · Metabase · Git

Product strategy. User-Centered Design · Product Discovery · Research-to-Roadmap Translation · AI/ML product UX

Leadership. UX Strategy & Roadmap · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Team Leadership · Executive Communication

Research Projects at UW

Robot Design in VR at HCDE

Sep 2017 - Feb 2019

NSF-Funded Research Lead - Led 5-year field study on embodied, multimodal collaboration in a shared VR robotics platform (educational context)

- **Published 2 peer-reviewed conference papers** demonstrating research impact and academic rigor
- Conducted comprehensive user research including surveys, usability testing, and contextual inquiry
- Studied how two participants with **asymmetric views (embodied/spatial vs. abstract/catalog)** coordinated, repaired communication breakdowns, and built trust to co-build prototypes

Digital Badge for STEM Education at iSchool

Sep 2015 - Dec 2016

Graduate Researcher - Designed digital achievement framework for Pacific Science Center Seattle

- **Published a peer-reviewed conference paper** on research methodology and outcomes
 - Executed user-centered design process through surveys and in-depth interviews with target demographic
 - Collaborated with designers to translate research findings into practical digital badge system implementation
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Education

University of Washington | *Master's in Information Science*

Human-Computer Interaction Specialization (Ph.D program)

- Research methods: User interviews, usability testing, survey analysis, case studies, field studies

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | *Master's in Psychology*

Cognitive Neuroscience Specialization

- Research methods: Lab-based behavioral experiment, fMRI

Korea University | *Master's in Experimental Psychology*

Visual Perception Specialization

- Research methods: Lab-based experiment, psychophysics, eye tracking

Korea University | *Bachelor's in Psychology and English Literature*